

of tabs amongst current browsers. You can open a new tab by middle-clicking your mouse on any empty area of the Page Bar, or via [Ctrl] + [N]. You can also close an open tab by middle-clicking directly on the tab. Middle-clicking on a link will open the link in a background tab. To close a tab, press [Ctrl] + [W]; to close all tabs, press [Ctrl] + [Alt] + [W]; to close all tabs but the one you're in, press [Ctrl] + [Alt] + [Shift] + [W]. This might seem like an awful lot to remember, but you'll get used to it once you start using it regularly!

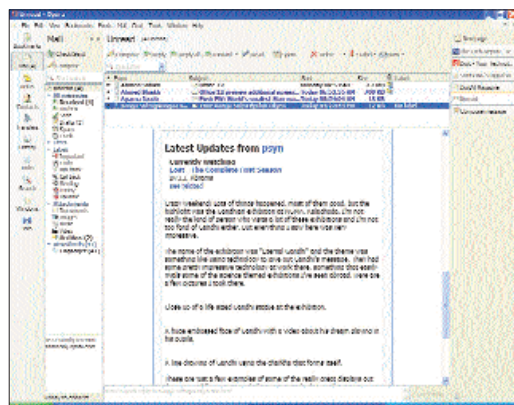
You can cycle forward through open tabs by pressing [Ctrl] + [Tab]; this can also be done by keeping the right mouse button pressed and rolling the scroll wheel. Incidentally, using the scroll wheel while keeping the *left* mouse button pressed will zoom in and out of the page—note that this zooms both the fonts and the images. You can maximise a tab by pressing [F11]; pressing [Ctrl] + [F11] will fit all text to the horizontal size of the window, thus eliminating the dreaded horizontal scroll in a Web page.

Mouse gestures are a novel way to navigate Opera. Those of you using Firefox might be familiar with mouse gestures if you have the extension that enables it. When you first use a gesture—perhaps accidentally—Opera will ask if you wish to enable the feature; click on [Yes]. For example, you can hold the right mouse button and draw an “L” onto a Web page to tell Opera to close it. Here are some other gestures you can use (with right mouse button):

MOUSE GESTURE	ACTION
Move down	Open new window
Move up and down	Reload
Move up, then right	Restore or maximise window
Move down, then left	Minimise window
Move down, then up	Duplicate window
Move down, then right	Close window

Communication 2.0

Opera comes with a very capable e-mail engine called M2 that allows for quick searches both on the subject and the content of an e-mail message. Moreover, the engine is flexible enough to be used as an RSS feed reader. To enable the mail client, go to **Tools > Mail And Chat Accounts**. Opera will then take you through the setup process. You can now open the e-mail panel by pressing [Ctrl] + [3]. The M2 mail client auto-



Opera's e-mail client; note that the two mails with attachments are automatically filtered under Archives in the left Mail panel

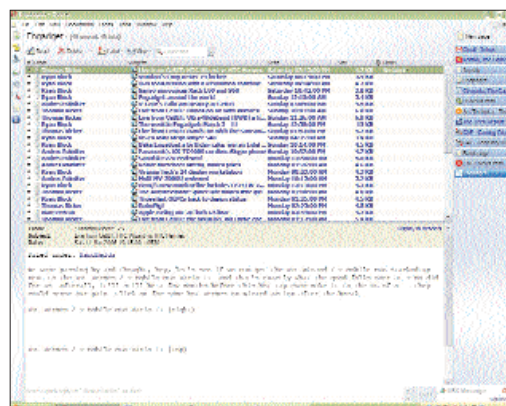
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matically filters your e-mails into preset categories. For example, all incoming mails with attachments will be found under the Attachments heading in the Mail panel. Moreover, there is further filtering into documents, image, music, video, and archive attachments. You can use this feature to quickly track down a particular mail.

Also note the Label field here. As you can guess, you can label each message with a particular tag—say Important, Mail back, Funny, or whatever. This helps in managing your mail, and is a feature similar to the Star feature in Gmail. Speaking of which, much like Gmail, Opera can send a quick reply to a mail. This is done simply by typing in some text in the Quick Reply field that accompanies each mail and then hitting the button. A quick reply quotes the original mail and appends your entered text to the beginning.

You can change the default signature while sending mails: go to **Tools > Mail And Chat Accounts**, select your e-mail account, and click on Edit. Now head to the last tab, titled Outgoing—you can use a custom signature by typing it in here. If you have a back-and-forth communication ongoing, the M2 mail client will track the conversation under the Active Threads heading. Moreover, M2 can track the contacts you converse with. Such contacts will be listed under the Active Contacts heading. You can also manually add a contact by right-clicking on an e-mail ID and choosing “Add to contacts.”

The mail engine is also capable of fetching your RSS feeds and mailing lists. Subscription to an RSS feed works much the same way that it does under Firefox—if a Web page has Atom or RSS feed subscription, a feed icon will appear in Opera's address bar. To subscribe, click on the icon. RSS feeds are listed in the Mail panel under Newsfeeds. Once again, the best thing about M2 is that it is searchable in its entirety—you can therefore search the contents of an e-mail and of



Reading RSS feeds under Opera

all your RSS feeds using the same Start Search window in the e-mail panel. Note that you can also search for a contact using [Ctrl] + [4] and search through your notes using [Ctrl] + [6].

The M2 mail client has a spam filter that functions on a whitelist. This means that it will tag suspicious messages as spam unless you manually tell it not to. You can also create fil-